

PERMANENCE IN A PRECARIOUS WORLD

Blue denotes PPT Slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: Hebrews 12:25-28 (NKJV) *“See that you do not refuse Him who speaks. For if they did not escape who refused Him who spoke on earth, much more shall we not escape if we turn away from Him who speaks from heaven,²⁶ whose voice then shook the earth; but now He has promised, saying, “Yet once more I shake not only the earth, but also heaven.”²⁷ Now this, “Yet once more,” indicates the removal of those things that are being shaken, as of things that are made, that the things which cannot be shaken may remain.²⁸ Therefore, since we are receiving a kingdom which cannot be shaken, let us have grace, by which we may serve God acceptably with reverence and godly fear.”*

INTRO: Permanence = The condition or quality of being permanent; perpetual or continued existence. (dictionary.com)

Precarious = Exposed to or involving danger; dangerous; perilous; or risky. (dictionary.com)

I think all of us could agree, we are living in precarious times:

- In 1963 the Bible was kicked out of our schools and the public square... The public school system is out of control Aand the public square is going to hell in a hand basket. June 8, 1845, **President Andrew Jackson** said, *“The Bible is the rock upon which our Republic rests.”* Abraham Lincoln said of the Bible, *“In regards to this great book, the Bible, I have but this to say. It is the best gift God has given to man. All the good the savior gave to the world was*

communicated through this book. But for it, we would not know right from wrong.”

- Roe Vs. Wade has killed more than 58 million unborn babies... (LEAVE THIS ON THE SCREEN WHILE I TALK ABOUT THIS SEGMENT) That is half the current population of this nation! Have the people number off 1 – 5 Have all 5's to keep standing and everyone else to sit down. Because of abortion all the 5's would be dead! According to the National Right To Life Committee, as of December 31, 2015 58,586,256 babies have been aborted since Roe Vs. Wade. For every person murdered this year around the world, more than a million unborn babies have been legally exterminated since Roe Vs. Wade.
- Many Americans do not want “*In God we trust*” on their money... The dollar has taken a beating in world markets and

we are almost \$20 Trillion dollars in debt!

- Many Americans do not want “*One nation under God*” in the pledge... We are quickly becoming the laughing stock of the world! The Pilgrims came to our shores in 1620 seeking religious liberty. Before they disembarked they went beneath the deck and had a prayer meeting. The prayer meeting led them to write a covenant called the “*Mayflower Compact*” The Mayflower Compact began with these words: “*In the name of God, Amen!*”
- In June 2015, the Supreme Court redefined marriage... This is not over! It is just beginning! Many university academics are now saying that pedophilia is “*natural and normal for males.*” An academic conference held at the University of Cambridge said that “*pedophilia interest is natural and normal for males and that at least a*

sizeable minority of normal males would like to have sex with children.” The Canadian Supreme Court just legalized some sex acts with animals. The particular case they ruled on is too gross for me to even cite it here in this venue. America and the world are teetering on a precarious cliff of immorality. Let me sound an alarm, the Supreme Court does not have the right to redefine marriage because it doesn’t belong to them. God ordained marriage between a man and a woman, before he ever created a human being. Just because you have a law degree, a lifetime appointment to the bench, a black robe, and a Washington D.C. address, does not mean you have the right to do such a thing. I am here to serve notice on the Supreme Court, Marriage is still between a man and a woman and no one else qualifies. A court much higher than the Supreme Court recognizes no other kind of

marriage than that of a man and woman!
Every Supreme Court Justice will give
an account to God, and each one of them
will bow and declare that Jesus Christ is
Lord to the glory of God the Father!

Proverbs 14:34 *“Righteousness exalts a
nation but sin is a reproach to any
people.”* (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL
NEXT SLIDE) The world is in a
precarious place!

- The U.S. military has run the gamete
between exclusion of gay's from the
military – Don't ask don't tell – to
allowing the openly homosexual to
serve! The Pentagon recently announced
that if an individual can document that
18 months before enlisting, they
presented as the opposite sex, the
military would now pay for sex change
operations! Jeremiah 49:22 *“Behold he
shall come up and fly like an eagle, and
spread his wings over Bozrah: And at
that day shall the heart of the mighty*

men of Edom be as the heart of a woman in her pangs.” (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF this BULLET POINT) America is on a precariously slippery slope! God is saying, he will judge the mighty nation by turning her mightiest warriors into a woman in labor! The director of the ACLU just resigned over President Obama’s decision on transgendered restroom use. It seems a man traumatized her very own daughters in a women’s restroom. Alexander Hamilton said, *“People get the kind of government they deserve.”*

- Terrorism threatens the safety of the world... From January – June 2016 there have been 838 terroristic events in the world, resulting in the death of at least 8,368 and more than 10,655 injured. In that same period of time there have only been 10 day’s that no terrorist attack has occurred. In America - January 7, 2016 a

police officer was shot in his marked car in West Philadelphia. February 11, 2016 four people were injured in a machete attack in Ohio. June 12, 2016 Orlando Florida, 49 killed and 53 injured. This very week 2 African American men were shot to death by police officers in Minnesota and Louisiana. Everyone is entitled to due process. ***“The person who judges a matter without hearing all the facts is a fool.”*** This resulted in 5 police officers being killed and 11 injured in Dallas.

- The gay agenda is marching forward, as Americans stand idly by. Does it strike you as odd that 1% of the population can impose its will on the other 99%? On June 26, 2015 the Supreme Court ruled that same sex couples have the same right as opposite sex couples, to marry in all fifty states. As a result of this ruling the White House was lighted in rainbow colors showing support for the decision.

The White house was not the only building or landmark to display the rainbow colors. Others included: (1) The Empire State Building. (2) The tower atop One World Trade Center in New York City. (3) The 35-W bridge in Minneapolis Minnesota. (4) The Federal Courthouse in St. Louis, MO. (5) The Long Center for the performing arts in Austin, TX. (6) Niagara Falls between New York state and Ontario, Canada. (7) The Capitol Building in San Juan, Puerto Rico. (8) The Seattle Great Wheel, in Washington State. (9) The Denver City and County Building in Denver, CO. (10) Playhouse Square in Cleveland, OH. (11) The Idaho Capital Building in Boise Idaho. (12) The California State Capitol Building in Sacramento, CA. (13) San Francisco International Airport in San Francisco, CA. (14) City Hall in San Francisco, CA. (15) Grace Cathedral in San Francisco, CA

- A devil worshipper recently offered the opening prayer at a Phoenix city council meeting. The same thing is set to happen in Pensacola Florida in a few days!

Psalm 9:17 ***"The wicked shall be turned into hell, and all the nations that forget God."*** (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL

NEXT SLIDE) America is in a precarious place!

- The moral fabric of our society lies in ruin... (Good is bad, bad is good) The religious establishment cannot decide what is right and what is wrong. Pastors are fearful of calling people out for their sin. Proverbs 29:2 ***"When the righteous are in authority, the people rejoice: when the wicked rule the people mourn."*** (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF THIS SEGMENT) James Madison the fourth President of the United States, and architect of the constitution said, *"We have staked the whole future of American civilization not*

upon the power of government, far from it. We have staked the future upon the capacity of each and all of us to govern ourselves, and to sustain ourselves according to the Ten Commandments of God.” America is in a precarious place!
“Righteousness exalts a nation, sin is a reproach to all people.”

On April 30, 1789 George Washington said, *“My fervent supplications to that Almighty being who rules over the universe, who presides in the council of the nations, and whose providential aid can supply every human defect, that His benediction may consecrate to the liberties and happiness of the people of the United States, a government instituted by themselves for these essential purposes.”* He goes on to say, *“We ought to be no less persuaded that the propitious smiles of Heaven can never be expected on a nation that disregards the eternal rules of order and right, which*

Heaven itself has ordained.”

On Tuesday, April 26, 2016 President Barak Obama said, *“We’re fortunate to be living in the most peaceful, most prosperous, most progressive era in human history.”* (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL I AM FINISHED TALKING ABOUT THE MIDDLE CLASS)

I am not sure what rock President Obama, the Congress, the Democrats and the Republicans are living under, I can tell you we are living in DANGEROUS DAYS! Our culture and world is being shaken! Let me sound an alarm this morning: liberty will only last as long as character and responsibility are in vogue! Go to any third world country and the thing you will be smitten by is there is NO middle class. When liberty disappears, so does the middle class.

In spite of this, it is possible to experience permanence in a precarious world.

I'm afraid the American church wants an Americanized Christianity that:

- Faces no obstacles...
- Suffers no opposition... Dietrich Bonhoeffer said, "*Suffering is not an interruption, but our calling.*"
- Expects only blessings...
- Demands no lifestyle change...
- Does not have to stare down any criticism... Peter and John said, "*We must speak the things we have seen and heard.*"
- Does not actually change the culture where it is located...

The American style of Christianity wants the blessings of God without having to live by the boundaries of the Word of God!

While it is true that the world is a precarious place, the church is dangerously close to being irrelevant and inconsequential.

What is the answer? Can we fix it with a political shift? While the church had better get up off the couch and go vote the real answer is found in [2 Chronicles 7:14 \(KJV\)](#)

“If my people, which are called by my name, shall humble themselves, and pray, and seek my face, and turn from their wicked ways; then will I hear from heaven, and will forgive their sin, and will heal their land.” (END OF SERMON #1 –
LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF
ALTAR SERVICE)

I. WE NEED THE GRIT TO FACE THE FACTS OF A PRECARIOUS WORLD...

There are people in this room today, whose lives have been shaken by one or more of the things I talked about last week.

Take it from someone who has first-hand experience with things being shaken,
“Tough times don’t last but tough people do.” God is able to deliver permanence in a precarious world.

What I am calling grit is simply faith in that which cannot be shaken. Faith in God will give you:

- The guts of a skydiver...
- A head like a piece of granite
- A backbone like an oak log...
- The tenacity of a hungry lion...

Permanence in a precarious world can only be achieved by holding to God’s unchanging hand.

Things are being shaken in our culture the question for everyone here today is; *“What are we putting our faith in?”*

Where have we placed our faith? Have we placed our faith in people? Have we placed our faith in government? Have we placed our faith in this world's system?

All of these things will fail us! Permanence in a precarious world comes from placing our faith in the Lord! (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

If our faith is founded upon the God of Heaven you will make it! R.W. Shambach made famous the statement, *“You don't have any trouble, all you need is faith in God.”*

Remember this, *“When the going get's tough, the tough get going.”*

It is no small thing for a person to be able to stand amidst the ruins of a home, a business, a family, or a dream, and proclaim, *“Even so, my faith has not been shaken!”*

Toward the beginning of the Second World War, the mayor of the Norwegian seaport of Narvik surveyed the disastrous results of the city that had been seized by the Germans, bombarded by the British, and pounded again and again by relentless bombing raids. Responding to reporters, the mayor looked at the wreckage around him and then looked at the distant snow capped mountain peaks that looked peacefully down upon the city and he said, “*The mountain’s are still ours!*”

Psalm 121:1-2 (NKJV) “*I will lift up my eyes to the hills—From whence comes my help? 2 My help comes from the Lord, Who made heaven and earth.*”

Psalm 125:2 (KJV) “*As the mountains are round about Jerusalem, so the Lord is round about his people from henceforth even for ever.*”

II. IN A PRECARIOUS WORLD WE MUST CLING TO THE THINGS THAT CANNOT BE SHAKEN...

In order to reestablish permanence in a precarious world we need not look any further than the Word of God.

In the face of terrorism, racial unrest, and economic uncertainty, there remain some things that we cannot allow to change among us:

- Love... Ephesians 4:1-2 (NKJV) ***“I, therefore, the prisoner of the Lord, beseech you to walk worthy of the calling with which you were called, 2 with all lowliness and gentleness, with longsuffering, bearing with one another in love.”*** We are called to reach across all barriers with the Love of Christ. We must love the world with His love. We must love one another with His love. Jesus – ***“They will know you are***

my disciples because you love one another.”

- Peace... Ephesians 4:3 (NKJV)
“Endeavoring to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace.” As Christians we do not attempt to even the score, we walk and live in peace. Permanence in a precarious world requires peaceful words and actions among Christ followers. We do not *“Return railing for railing, or accusation for accusation; but blessing for cursing.”*
- Unity... Ephesians 4:4-6 (NKJV)
“There is one body and one Spirit, just as you were called in one hope of your calling. 5 one Lord, one faith, one baptism; 6 one God and Father of all, who is above all, and through all, and in you all.” Christ followers must go beyond walking in love and seeking peace, to living in a common faith that brings about unity! Unity doesn’t just

happen. Unity requires effort.

CONCLUSION:

Satan would like nothing better than to divide us along racial lines. Sin and selfishness will cause us to retaliate in vengeance for wrongs committed, and then those acts of retaliation will elicit responses of a defensive nature and the cycle will continue and escalate.

Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. said it well, when in his speeches, he called notice to America's "*promissory note*" in our founding documents. That "*promissory note*" is that "*All men are created equal by God and have the right to life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness.*" (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

Martin Luther King had it right and so did the founders of this Nation - Our rights come from God. Our value as human beings

comes from God. My rights end where yours begin, and your rights end where mine begin. Take God out of it, and there is no unifying principle.

No amount of laws or resolutions from Congress, constitutional conventions, protest marches, retaliatory shootings, facebook postings, or twitter statements will solve this problem of racial tension we face today.

The love of God being demonstrated in a precarious world is the only thing that can bring permanence to our culture.

We of different races can live together, worship together, fellowship together and support one another for this simple reason.

We have:

- ONE Lord...
- ONE faith...
- ONE God...
- ONE Father...

- ONE Spirit...
- ONE Hope...

Our collective eyes are on Jesus Christ.

1 John 4:20 (NKJV) *“If someone says, “I love God,” and hates his brother, he is a liar; for he who does not love his brother whom he has seen, how can[a] he love God whom he has not seen?”*

1 Corinthians 13:1-8 (NKJV) *“Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, but have not love, I have become sounding brass or a clanging cymbal. 2 And though I have the gift of prophecy, and understand all mysteries and all knowledge, and though I have all faith, so that I could remove mountains, but have not love, I am nothing. 3 And though I bestow all my goods to feed the poor, and though I give my body to be burned, but have not love, it profits me nothing.*

4 Love suffers long and is kind; love does not envy; love does not parade itself, is not puffed up; 5 does not behave rudely, does not seek its own, is not provoked, thinks no evil; 6 does not rejoice in iniquity, but rejoices in the truth; 7 bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things. 8 Love never fails.”